the Outeniqua Mountains near George. He was only 32.

Hansie erred in communicating with betting syndicates and his mistakes were well publicised, but these should not obscure his immense contribution to South African cricket between 1992 and 2000, scoring more than 9 000 runs and captaining the national team to no fewer than 27 Test victories and 99 ODI wins, effectively building the stage upon which so many other Protea cricketers, including me, have been able to perform.

Our season continued with an important 21–6 victory over Boys' High and a free-flowing 37–28 win at Waterkloof, when we played some enjoyable, fast, attacking rugby, and made steady progress in the Beeld Trophy, winning a quarterfinal and semifinal, and so securing our place in the final.

Another perfect sunny day, another huge crowd, another massive occasion: our final opponents were Waterkloof, again, but this was a much tighter game and, although we dominated territory in the opening 20 minutes, we needed to start building a score. We won a lineout on the right-hand side of the field and, impulsively departing from the game plan, I decided to attempt a drop goal. Thankfully, the kick passed between the posts.

We scored a try in the corner soon afterwards, but midway through the second half I fell awkwardly in a tackle and dislocated my elbow. It was agony. The bone literally popped out of the socket. The medic calmly stretched my arm and popped it back but, for a scary moment, my sporting career had hung in the balance.

I was forced to leave the field but my teammates went on to secure a 19–16 win, claiming the Beeld Trophy and ensuring we finished the 2002 season with a record of played 23, won 22 and lost one. Our average number of points per match was 32 and our average margin of victory was 17.5 – not bad, not bad at all.

Beyond playing high-school rugby for Affies, there were also